English • Character, trust and narrative craft

Hazrat Asma (RA)

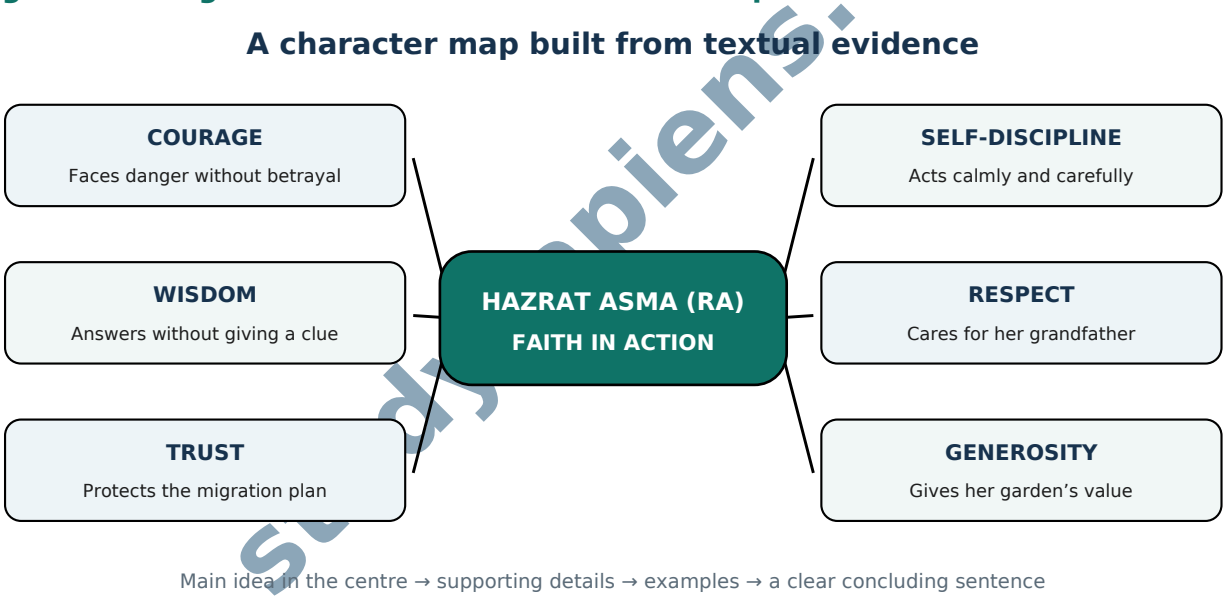
Official activities • Vocabulary • Tenses • Non-finite verbs • Interview • Narrative

Unit 4 • Complete official activities • Character, Trust and Responsibility

Text at a glance

• **Hazrat Asma bint Abu Bakr (RA)** is presented as a model of courage, wisdom, generosity, resolute faith, trustworthiness and self-discipline.
• **Historical focus:** Her services during the migration of the Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique (RA) from Makkah to Madinah in 622 CE.
• **Title:** Zaat-un-Nitaqain, associated with her use of her belt to secure food for the journey.
• **Language focus:** Context clues, dictionary skills, word families, past tenses, gerunds, infinitives, participles and narrative writing.

Figure 1 — Original evidence-based character map



Main idea in the centre → supporting details → examples → a clear concluding sentence

Honorifics: RA means "may Allah be pleased with her/him"; PBUH means "peace and blessings of Allah be upon him". The answers follow the events stated in the unit.

Pre-Reading and While-Reading

P1. Describe the role of a female family member in making your family happy and successful.

Model response: My mother coordinates our routines, listens when we face difficulties and encourages us to continue our education. She manages responsibilities patiently and teaches us to resolve disagreements respectfully. Her practical help and emotional support create stability, allowing every family member to work with confidence.

P2. Have you heard of Hazrat Asma (RA)? What do you know about her?

She was the daughter of Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique (RA), an early Muslim and a courageous supporter of the migration to Madinah. She prepared and carried food, protected the secret of the travellers' location and received the title Zaat-un-Nitaqain. She is also remembered for wisdom, generosity and steadfast faith.

Margin questions. Quick answers in passage order.

Question	Answer
Who migrated from Makkah to Madinah in 622 CE?	The Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and his close companion Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique (RA).
What title was given to Hazrat Asma (RA), and why?	Zaat-un-Nitaqain, because she used her own belt to tie and secure the food on the camel when nothing else was available.
What did she do when Abu Jehl demanded her father's whereabouts?	She politely asked, "How would I know?", giving no clue. Even after being slapped, she remained steadfast and protected the secret.
How did she alleviate her blind grandfather's concern?	She placed pebbles where her father had kept money and jewels, covered them with cloth and let him touch them. He believed provision had been left and felt relieved.
Which family relations are named in the text?	Daughter of Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique (RA); granddaughter of Hazrat Abu Quhafaa; stepsister of Hazrat Ayesha Siddiqa (RA) in the textbook wording; wife of Hazrat Zubair bin al-Awwam (RA); mother of Hazrat Abdullah bin Zubair (RA).

Reading and Critical Thinking

A. Answer the following questions.

1. How did Hazrat Asma's (RA) actions demonstrate resourcefulness and courage? Give examples.

She prepared provisions and, when no rope was available, used her own belt to secure them—an immediate practical solution. She repeatedly crossed a rugged mountain path at night to deliver food despite the danger of detection. When Abu Jehl violently demanded information, she answered without revealing anything and remained firm even after being slapped. Her creativity therefore served a purpose, while her courage protected people and a trust.

2. How can her qualities be applied to contemporary situations of trust and integrity? Give a real-life example.

A person should protect confidential information, complete promised work carefully and avoid seeking praise by exposing another person's private affairs. For example, a student trusted with a classmate's medical information should share it only with an authorized teacher when safety requires it, not gossip about it. If pressured by friends, the student can decline politely, just as Hazrat Asma (RA) refused to betray the travellers' secret.

3. Summarize the key challenges she faced and how she overcame them.

• **Search and threat:** Makkan chiefs offered rewards for the travellers, so she prepared carefully and acted discreetly.

• **Supply problem:** She found no fastening material, so she used her belt.

• **Dangerous route:** She crossed rocky terrain at night with food, attending to every detail.

• **Violent questioning:** She gave Abu Jehl no clue and stayed resolute despite physical harm.

• **Family anxiety:** She reassured her elderly, blind grandfather through a creative arrangement that eased his fear.

4. How did she handle the trust placed in her by her father and the Holy Prophet (PBUH), and ensure the migration's safety and success?

She treated preparation, food delivery and secrecy as one connected responsibility. Reliable provisions sustained the travellers; discreet night journeys reduced the chance of discovery; careful attention prevented small mistakes; and silence under questioning concealed their location. Her loyalty was active rather than merely verbal: every choice protected the people and the mission entrusted to her.

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5. How did her self-discipline contribute to effective handling of difficult situations?

Self-discipline enabled her to plan before acting, work quietly, repeat a demanding task and control fear during confrontation. She did not panic, boast or respond with an impulsive revelation. Her polite counterquestion shows mental restraint under pressure. Because she governed her emotions, her courage remained purposeful and her resourcefulness produced safe, timely solutions.

6. How did she show respect for herself and others? Provide specific examples.

She preserved her dignity by answering firmly without using abusive language, even towards an aggressor. She respected the Holy Prophet (PBUH) and her father through dependable service and confidentiality. She respected her grandfather by taking his anxiety seriously rather than mocking his blindness or beliefs. Her generosity to the poor and her welcome to everyone at her door extended that respect to the wider community.

7. How did she respect her grandfather although he was a disbeliever at that time, and how did this align with her values?

She listened to his fear that the family had been left helpless and acted immediately to comfort him. The pebbles beneath the cloth were a compassionate attempt to alleviate anxiety, not a scheme to seize property. Her conduct shows that faith and moral commitment did not cancel kindness to an elderly relative; family care, patience and generosity remained binding values.

B. Choose the correct option.

1. Which action demonstrated her handling of trust?

(d) all of the above. Preparing food, protecting her father's whereabouts and securing the supplies were all responsible fulfilment of trust.

2. Her response to Abu Jehl showed:

(b) self-discipline. She remained controlled and gave no useful information.

3. How did she respect her grandfather?

(b) by alleviating his concern with a creative solution.

4. Which action best exemplifies justice in her conduct?

(a) her confrontation with Abu Jehl. She calmly resisted wrongful aggression without betraying others; her care for her grandfather more directly exemplifies compassion.

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5. How is her generosity highlighted?

(a) selling her inherited garden and giving the money to the poor.

Concise unit summary

• Hazrat Asma (RA) helped prepare the migration of the Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique (RA) in 622 CE. She secured food with her belt, carried provisions along a dangerous mountain path and protected the travellers' secret when Abu Jehl confronted her. She also comforted her blind grandfather and later gave away the value of an inherited garden to people in need. Her life exemplifies faith, resourcefulness, courage, self-discipline, respect and generosity.

Vocabulary and Dictionary Skills

A. Infer meanings from context clues.

Word	Context-based meaning	Useful clue
capture	seize or take prisoner	rewards offered for the travellers, "dead or alive"
delicate	requiring great care; highly sensitive	even a slight mistake could endanger a life
endangered	put in danger	a mistake could threaten the Holy Prophet's (PBUH) life
rugged	rough, rocky and uneven	the difficult mountain path to the cave

B. Dictionary meaning, pronunciation, part of speech and etymology.

Word / pronunciation / POS	Dictionary meaning	Etymology
advocacy /ˈædvəkəsi/ • noun	public support for a cause or policy	through Old French from Latin *advocare*, "call to one's aid"
catalyst /ˈkætəlɪst/ • noun	a substance that speeds a reaction; a person or event causing rapid change	Greek *katalysis*, "dissolution", from *katalyein*
empowerment /ɪmˈpaʊəmənt/ • noun	the process of becoming stronger or gaining authority and control	English *em-* + *power* + *-ment*; power entered through Old French

Word / pronunciation / POS	Dictionary meaning	Etymology
resilience /rɪˈzɪliəns/ • noun	the capacity to recover from difficulty	Latin *resilire*, “leap back”, from *re-* + *salire*
substantial /səbˈstænʃəl/ • adjective	large in amount, value or importance; solidly based	Latin *substantialis*, from *substantia*, “substance”

C. Different word patterns.

Base word	Noun forms	Adjective forms	Adverb forms
bounty	bounty, bounties	bountiful, bounteous	bountifully, bounteously
determine	determination, determiner	determined, determinable	determinedly
infuriate	infuriation, fury	infuriating, infuriated	infuriatingly
prepare	preparation, preparedness	prepared, preparatory	preparedly (rare)
reward	reward	rewarding, rewarded	rewardingly (rare)

Not every base word has an equally common adverb. Use the rarer forms only when they fit naturally; otherwise rewrite the sentence with an ordinary phrase.

D. Sentences using each form of “determine”.

1. Determine (verb): We must determine the facts before making a decision.

2. Determination (noun): Her determination helped her complete the difficult task.

3. Determined (adjective): The determined student revised until she understood the topic.

4. Determinable (adjective): The exact cost is determinable from the written budget.

5. Determinedly (adverb): He worked determinedly despite repeated interruptions.

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Grammar: Tenses and Non-Finite Verbs

A. Identify the verbs and their tenses in the textbook passage.

Verb / verb group	Identification
faced	simple past
had prepared	past perfect—preparation completed before the journey
began	simple past
were travelling	past continuous
was continuously checking	past continuous
ensuring	present participle; part of the ongoing action, not a separate finite tense
had already secured	past perfect
tying	gerund after the preposition “by”
earning	present participle introducing a result
were evident	simple past linking verb
faced (each obstacle)	simple past

B. Rewrite the passage in the simple present tense.

Simple-present version

• Hazrat Asma (RA) courageously faces many challenges during the migration. She prepares food and supplies for the Holy Prophet (PBUH) and her father, Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique (RA), before they begin their journey. While they travel through the desert, Hazrat Asma (RA) continuously checks their provisions and ensures their safety. She already secures their food by tying it with her belt and earns the title of Zaat-un-Nitaqain. Her steadfastness and bravery are evident as she faces each obstacle with unwavering faith.

Grammar focus: This is a tense-transformation exercise. Historical narration normally remains in past tenses; the simple-present version above is supplied only because the activity requests it.

C. Write 5–6 sentences about a challenging situation using three past tenses.

Model paragraph — A difficult science exhibition

• Last month, I discovered that our science model had stopped working just before the exhibition. I had tested it successfully the previous night, so the sudden fault surprised me. While my teammates were explaining the problem to our teacher, I checked every connection carefully. I found a loose wire and repaired it before the judges arrived. Our model worked perfectly, and we felt proud because we had remained calm under pressure.

D. Identify gerunds, infinitives and participles.

Bold item	Form and function
Preparing food for the journey was her responsibility.	Preparing — gerund; head of the subject phrase
She decided to support her family.	to support — to-infinitive after “decided”
She received the title for tying the food.	tying — gerund after the preposition “for”
Honoured by her resourcefulness, …	Honoured — past participle introducing an adjectival phrase
She continued to help the needy.	to help — to-infinitive after “continued”

E. Complete with the correct verb form.

1. showing: Hazrat Asma (RA) was known for showing great courage. (gerund after “for”)

2. preparing: She helped her father by preparing supplies. (gerund after “by”)

3. being: The Holy Prophet (PBUH) praised her for being resourceful. (gerund after “for”)

4. Facing: Facing many challenges, Hazrat Asma (RA) remained steadfast. (present-participle phrase)

5. to give: She chose to give away her inherited garden. (infinitive after “chose”)

Oral Communication Skills

A. Role-play: a journalist interviews an Islamic scholar.

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Model interview

• **Journalist:** Why is Hazrat Asma (RA) remembered as Zaat-un-Nitaqain?
Scholar: The title recalls her practical service in securing food with her belt when preparing for the migration.
• **Journalist:** Which event best reveals her courage?
Scholar: Her confrontation with Abu Jehl is especially striking. She protected the secret despite violence and did not allow fear to control her answer.
• **Journalist:** Was resourcefulness different from courage?
Scholar: Yes. Resourcefulness is finding effective solutions with what is available, such as using a belt or pebbles. Courage is the strength to carry out those solutions despite danger.
• **Journalist:** What does her treatment of her grandfather teach us?
Scholar: It teaches compassion and family respect across differences in belief. She responded to his anxiety rather than dismissing him.
• **Journalist:** How can young people apply these values today?
Scholar: They can keep promises, protect legitimate confidentiality, help relatives, remain calm in crises and use their abilities to serve others.
• **Journalist:** What is her lasting significance?
Scholar: She shows that faith becomes visible through responsible action, generosity and moral courage.

B. Discussion on "Handling of Trust".

Model discussion contribution

• Handling trust means accepting a responsibility and protecting it through both competence and honesty. Hazrat Asma (RA) did not merely promise help: she prepared supplies, found a fastening solution, travelled carefully and withheld sensitive information under pressure. In modern life, trustworthiness may mean returning borrowed property, safeguarding a password or completing assigned team work. We should also recognize limits: if someone's safety is at risk, a responsible person seeks qualified help rather than treating secrecy as absolute.

Listening and responding: Use turns such as "I agree because ...", "Could you clarify your example?" and "I see your point, but we should also consider safety." Correct pronunciation, calm intonation and reference to evidence make a contribution persuasive.

Writing Skills: Narrative

Official process. Plan → draft → revise → edit → finalize → seek feedback.

Planning element	Model decisions
Pivotal moment	Abu Jehl confronts Hazrat Asma (RA) on the night of migration.
Narrator and point of view	Third-person limited, following Hazrat Asma's (RA) perceptions.

Planning element	Model decisions
Main characters	Hazrat Asma (RA), Abu Jehl and the absent travellers whose safety depends on her.
Problem and significance	Violence and fear pressure her to reveal a secret that could endanger the migration.
Sequence	Preparation → night arrival → violent demand → controlled reply → slap and steadfast silence → reflection.

Final narrative — The Secret at the Door

• The food had been secured, and the quiet house finally seemed ready for the night. Hazrat Asma (RA) remembered tying the bundle with her own belt when nothing else could be found. Now every small sound outside made her pause. Somewhere among the rugged hills, the travellers depended on her silence as much as on the provisions she had prepared.

• Suddenly, a violent knocking shook the door. Abu Jehl stood outside, his face hard with fury. “Where is your father?” he demanded. For one brief moment, fear tightened around her, but she did not let it choose her words. She met the question with calm dignity: “How would I know?”

• The reply offered no direction, no name and no clue. Enraged, Abu Jehl struck her so forcefully that her ear-ring fell. The sharp pain could have provoked a cry or an angry outburst, yet she remained steadfast. Her purpose was clearer than his rage: she would not betray the trust placed in her. When the confrontation ended, the secret was still safe.

• That night, courage did not appear as a loud speech or a public display. It appeared as a measured answer and a silence maintained under pressure. Her self-discipline protected others, while her resourcefulness had already helped sustain their journey. The moment continues to teach that responsibility is tested most severely when doing the right thing is costly. Trust then becomes more than a promise; it becomes a deliberate act of bravery.

Revision check: The narrative uses chronological pacing, sensory detail, direct dialogue, a central conflict and a reflective conclusion. During editing, check past-tense consistency, paragraphing and punctuation of speech.

Original Exam-Practice MCQs

1. Which quality is shown by using her belt to secure food?

(a) indifference (b) resourcefulness
(c) hesitation (d) extravagance

Answer: (b) resourcefulness — She solved an immediate problem with available material.

2. The main purpose of her night journeys was to:

(a) deliver food (b) find jewellery
(c) meet Abu Jehl (d) sell a garden

Answer: (a) deliver food — She supplied the travellers in the cave.

3. Her counterquestion to Abu Jehl protected:

(a) a reward (b) the travellers' secret
(c) her grandfather's gold (d) a public speech

Answer: (b) the travellers' secret — It revealed no clue about their location.

4. "Had prepared" is:

(a) simple past (b) past continuous
(c) past perfect (d) present perfect

Answer: (c) past perfect — Had + past participle marks an earlier completed action.

5. "While they were travelling" contains:

(a) past continuous (b) simple present
(c) future perfect (d) past perfect

Answer: (a) past continuous — Were + travelling forms past continuous.

6. In "Preparing food was her responsibility", preparing is a:

(a) gerund (b) finite verb
(c) past participle (d) compound preposition

Answer: (a) gerund — The -ing form heads the noun-like subject.

7. After "chose", which form is correct?

(a) giving (b) to give
(c) given (d) gave

Answer: (b) to give — Choose is followed by a to-infinitive here.

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8. “Resilience” most nearly means:

(a) ability to recover (b) public support
(c) large size (d) rapid chemical change

Answer: (a) ability to recover — It is the capacity to withstand and recover from difficulty.

9. A narrative’s pacing controls:

(a) dictionary pronunciation (b) the speed at which events unfold
(c) the rhyme scheme (d) word etymology

Answer: (b) the speed at which events unfold — Writers vary pacing to create tension and emphasis.

10. Her sale of the inherited garden chiefly demonstrates:

(a) generosity (b) fear
(c) secrecy (d) pronunciation

Answer: (a) generosity — She gave the proceeds to poor and needy people.

Quick Vocabulary in Context

Word	Meaning and model use
perilous	dangerous: The perilous path required careful steps.
traverse	cross an area: She had to traverse rocky ground at night.
steadfast	firm and unwavering: She remained steadfast under pressure.
resolute	determined: A resolute person does not abandon a just purpose easily.
alleviate	make less severe: Kind words can alleviate anxiety.
beacon	a guiding light or example: Her life is a beacon of courage and generosity.

Points to Remember

622 CE: migration from Makkah to Madinah; Hazrat Asma (RA) supported preparation, supplies and secrecy.

Zaat-un-Nitaqain: title linked with securing food by means of her belt.

Character evidence: courage under threat; wisdom in speech; respect for grandfather; generosity to the poor.

Past perfect marks the earlier past; **past continuous** presents an action in progress.

Gerund: verb-ing as noun; **infinitive:** to + base verb; **participle:** verb form used adjectivally or in a phrase.

Dictionary work includes meaning, pronunciation, part of speech and etymology—not just a synonym.

Narrative writing needs a clear viewpoint, conflict, sequenced events, dialogue, pacing and reflection.

MCQ key at a glance

Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key
1	b	2	a	3	b	4	c	5	a
6	a	7	b	8	a	9	b	10	a

How to attempt this unit in the paper

- For character questions, join every quality to a specific event rather than listing adjectives alone.
- Distinguish trustworthiness from absolute secrecy: safety may require responsible disclosure to an authorized person.
- For tense transformation, change every finite verb consistently and check agreement.
- After a preposition, use a gerund; after verbs such as choose/decide, check whether a to-infinitive is required.
- In the narrative conclusion, explain why the pivotal moment matters instead of merely stopping the action.